



SOWK 588 (0): Advanced Policy Practice (3 credits)

Summer 2026, Online/Heritage at Toppenish

Instructor	Dr. Jacob Campbell, Ph.D., LICSW		
Office Hours	Toppenish Campus Office: Simpkins Hall, Office 2124 Drop-in: N/A	Tri-Cities Regional Site Office: 2 nd Floor Office 4209 Drop-in: N/A	
	Student meetings for summer available by arrangement. Schedule available at https://vsp.ink/now .		
	Phone	(509) 392-1056	Email
Dates	Synchronous engagement for this class takes place on selected Saturdays from 12 PM to 2 PM. Participation for the first three sessions will be available in a hybrid format. Student's may attend in-person at the Kennewick Campus in RM 4208 or via Zoom - https://heritage.zoom.us/my/dr.jacob . These sessions will include 05/30/26, 06/13/26, and 06/27/26.		
	The fourth synchronous class will be in-person and take place at the Toppenish campus in Violet Lumley Rau Center RM 1701. This class will be a special session include MSW program evaluation career support, and more with information forthcoming. This session will take place 07/11/26		

Land Acknowledgement

Heritage University occupies its home on the traditional lands of the Yakama People. These ancestral homelands are the Yakama, Palouse, Pisuouse, Wenatshapam, Klikatat, Klinquit, Kow- was-say-ee, Li-ay-was, Skin-pah, Wish-ham, Shyiks, Ochechotes, Kah-milt-pa, and Se-ap-cat, who today are represented by the Confederated Tribes and Bands of the Yakama Nation (Treaty of 1855) and, whose relationship with this land continues to this day. Heritage University, grounded in the vision of the two Yakama women founders, respects Indigenous peoples as traditional guardians of the lands and the enduring relationship that exists between Indigenous peoples and their traditional territories. We offer gratitude for the land itself, for those who have stewarded it for generations, and for the opportunity to study, learn, work, and be in community on this land. We acknowledge that our university's history, like many others, is fundamentally tied to the first colonial developments in the Yakima Valley. Finally, we respectfully acknowledge and honor past, present, and future Indigenous students who will journey through this home called Heritage University.

Course Description

Students will acquire a deeper understanding of social policies at the local, state, tribal, and federal levels in the context of policy implementation and advocacy impacts on oppressed and marginalized populations. Students will identify and explain social policy theories such as social construction, political economy, cost-benefit analysis, and feminist perspectives to analyze cases; understand

diverse client populations; create culturally tailored interventions; predict results; and evaluate outcomes. They will compare the Universal Declaration of Human Rights with the National Association of Social Workers (NASW) Code of Ethics, and social welfare policies in United States.

Relationship to Other Sequences and Other Courses

This course builds upon **SOWK 536 Introduction to Social Policy**, which introduces students to examining social policy in relation to social work practice. This course, **SOWK 588 Advanced Policy Practice**, provides students with a deeper understanding of policy and the context of that policy to address social problems.

Competencies, Performance Indicators, and Assessment Methods

In adult education, providing context for the content you teach helps learners understand the expectations placed on them. The Council on Social Work Education (CSWE, 2022) has defined the competencies that social work students are expected to demonstrate. At the generalist level, they share practice behaviors, where the advanced generalist practice behaviors were developed by the social work department. We assess these through key assignments throughout the MSW program curriculum and in students' practicum settings. The MSW program has also identified goals to guide it.

MSW Program Goals and Objectives

The MSW Program has the following goals for our students:

1. To prepare students with knowledge, values, skills, cognitive and affective processes.
2. To prepare students with advanced skills in social policy, research, culturally tailored interventions, and organizational and community leadership to enhance social functioning and alleviate poverty, oppression, and injustices.
3. To prepare students to improve people's lives; alleviate biopsychosocial concerns; empower individuals, families, groups, organizations, and communities; and achieve social justice.

Assignment Assessment Methods, Practice Behaviors, and Competencies

In the *Educational Policy and Accreditation Standards* (EPAS), the CSWE (2022) defines competence as "the ability to integrate and apply social work knowledge, values, skills, and cognitive and affective processes to practice situations in a culturally responsive, purposeful, intentional, and professional manner to promote human and community well-being" (p. 7). Competence is "informed by knowledge, values, skills, and cognitive and affective processes that include the social worker's critical thinking, affective reactions, and exercise of judgment in regard to unique practice situations" (p. 7).

The nine competencies identified in the 2022 EPAS are:

1. Demonstrate Ethical and Professional Behavior
2. Advance Human Rights and Social, Racial, Economic, and Environmental Justice
3. Engage Anti-Racism, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (ADEI) in Practice
4. Engage in Practice-Informed Research and Research-Informed Practice
5. Engage in Policy Practice
6. Engage with Individuals, Families, Groups, Organizations, and Communities
7. Assess Individuals, Families, Groups, Organizations, and Communities
8. Intervene with Individuals, Families, Groups, Organizations, and Communities

9. Evaluate Practice with Individuals, Families, Groups, Organizations, and Communities

The social work program has developed the curriculum with competencies as outcomes. Most required courses identify a specific competency for students to demonstrate and be assessed by faculty through a key assignment. The MSW Program has taken these competencies and designed associated advanced generalist practice behaviors. The content of the course also introduces and develops related competencies and behaviors. Students who complete this course will have demonstrated the competencies listed in the table below.

What will I do in this class? (Class Learning Assignment)	What knowledge/skills will I gain? (Practice Behaviors)	How does this work apply? (CSWE 2022 Competency)
Policy Advocacy Presentation	a. Utilize policy analysis skills to inform policy formulation practices and policy implementation effects on oppressed and marginalized populations, including rural and tribal communities. b. Organize legislative policy advocacy with individuals, families, groups, communities, and organizations to advance human rights and social, economic, and environmental justice.	Competency 2: Advance Human Rights and Social, Racial, Economic, and Environmental Justice
Policy Analysis Paper	a. Examine social welfare policies at local, state, tribal, and federal levels to summarize best practice recommendations. b. Assess social policy theory in the context of practice with diverse client populations and prepare recommendations for policy change.	Competency 5: Engage in Policy Practice

Texts, Materials, and Technology

Text(s)

Title: Rebooting Policy Analysis: Strengthening the Foundation, Expanding the Scope

Author(s): Peter Linquti

ISBN: Paper Back (9781544372600), eBook/kindle (9781544372624)

Edition/Copyright: First Edition, 2022

Publisher: CQ Press

Title: \$2.00 A Day: Living on Almost Nothing in America
Author(s): Kathryn J. Edin & H. Luke Shafer
ISBN: Paper Back (054481195X), eBook/kindle (978-0544811959)
Edition/Copyright: 2016
Publisher: Mariner Books

Supplements

Technology

Access to a laptop (PC, MacBook, etc.) or desktop and reliable internet access will be needed. Laptops can be checked out from the library (Unfortunately, iPads, tablets, and Chromebooks are not laptops. See the staff in the Donald K. North Library to check out a laptop). Our Learning Management System (LMS), MyHeritage, will be used to communicate ideas/instructions and upload assignments. Your faculty member will help you.

Supplemental Texts

The American Psychological Association (APA) is the designated writing style for this course. While not required, students can consider their prescriptive style guide (APA, 2020) to support them in this class. This is not required, and the publishers offer a valuable, comprehensive website with the information needed to meet the style expectations. There are a few resources that can be helpful for students to access during this course, including our profession's code of ethics, library guides, and some open-access resources.

Content	Link
Code of Ethics	NASW Code of Ethics
Social Work Library Guides	• Native Americans and Social Work • Latinos and Social Work
Other	Open Educational Resources (OER)

Assignments and Grading

I grade students on four significant assignments for SOWK 588. These include students' participation and engagement, both asynchronous and synchronous. Students complete a policy analysis advocacy project in which they draft a policy analysis paper and create a presentation video that translates their analysis into how they would engage stakeholders to advocate for policy change. Finally, there are two take-home exams for students to demonstrate knowledge of the course content. The following table delineates the assignments, their point values, and the percentages of the overall class grade.

Assignment	Points	Percentage
A-01: Asynchronous Participation and Engagement	100	20%
A-02: Synchronous Participation and Engagement	50	10%
A-03: Policy Analysis Advocacy Project		
A-03a: Social Policy Macro Issue	150	30%
A-03b: Policy Advocacy Presentation	100	20%
A-04: Take Home Exams	100	20%
TOTAL	500	100%

Grade Scale:

The grade scale table lists the assigned letter grade, its corresponding percentages, and its GPA.

Letter Grade	Percentage	GPA
A	93 to 100	4.0
A-	90 to 92.99	3.7
B+	87 to 89.99	3.3
B	83 to 86.99	3.0
B-	80 to 82.99	2.7
C+	77 to 79.99	2.3
C	73 to 76.99	2.0
C-	70 to 72.99	1.7
D+	67 to 69.99	1.3
D	63 to 66.99	1.0
D-	60 to 62.99	0.7
F	0 to 59.99	0.0

Course Assignments Descriptions

I have described each assignment with meta-information on implementation, the purpose, the specific tasks students are expected to complete, and the criteria used to assess it.

Assignment 01: Asynchronous Participation and Engagement

- Meta:** *Points* 12.5 pts each week or a total of 100 pts (20% of final grade); *Deadline* all expected replies are to be posted in the forums before 8 AM on Monday of each week; *Completion* via MyHeritage Forums.
- Purpose:** The forums are students' place to reflect on their learning and experiences, share new ideas, and engage with their peers. They are designed to enable students to connect in dialogue to promote the learning of social work knowledge, values, skills, and cognitive and affective processes.
- Task:** Each week, a set of forums will be available for students to participate in. Expect to spend three hours per week (for fully asynchronous weeks) and 1.5 hours during weeks with Saturday class sessions. The weekly unit on MyHeritage will specify the number of replies and the expectations for students that week. The quality of your writing, depth of reflection, and application of scholarship are all essential considerations in developing your replies. Students are encouraged to engage in conversation within the forum, but all replies, whether directed at a peer or responding to the forum's general prompts, should contribute to the overall conversation and provide substantive, meaningful perspectives. While students have the entire week to complete all required

replies, the expectation is that at least one reply be posted in the forums by Wednesday, and that half of the needed replies be completed before Saturday. Engaging early in the forums allows students to contribute meaningfully to the conversation and gives peers time to respond to their ideas.

Success: Students will review the assignments in MyHeritage and make at least the minimum required number of replies following the expectations set out for that week. The content of their replies should be of high quality. Unless specified in the forums, there is no specific word count, but meaningful replies are likely to be at least a few paragraphs.

Assignment 02: Synchronous Participation and Engagement

Meta: *Points* 50 pts (10% of final grade); *Deadline* the four identified Saturday class sessions; *Completion* via attendance and documentation taken by the instructor during class.

Purpose: The in-person class environment is structured to support students' development of policy skills. The synchronous class sessions provide opportunities for lecture, real-time discussions with peers, and eminently demonstration and practice of these skills.

Task: Students should come to class having completed the assigned readings and having begun engaging in the online forums. Students are expected to be fully prepared to participate in class and ready to practice their policy skills.

Success: Students will be present, on time, or have contacted the instructor for the class session. Students will fully engage in class activities and discussions.

Assignment 03: Policy Analysis Advocacy Project

The *Policy Analysis Advocacy Project* is the Key Assignment¹ for SOWK 588 and is used to assess CSWE (2022) competencies two and five. It includes two linked assignments, which guide students through the process of policy analysis and advocacy. First, students will critically examine a current social issue and related policy in a comprehensive written analysis. Then, building on that work, students will create a video presentation that translates their findings into a strategic, justice-focused advocacy plan.

Assignment 03a Policy Analysis Paper

Meta: *Points* 150 points (30% of final grade); *Deadline* is due no later than 08:00 AM on Monday 07/06/26; *Completion* file upload to Anthology through MyHeritage Assignments;

¹ Heritage University's social work program selects assignments across the curriculum for students to demonstrate the CSWE competencies and each practice behavior defined by the MSW program to act as key assignments. These assignments are submitted to Heritage's online portfolio, Anthology, and given to all students at each site using the same grading rubric. Student scores help provide data for faculty to self-evaluate the program.

- Purpose:** The *Policy Analysis Paper* is designed to enable students to demonstrate the skills necessary to understand and analyze social issues through the lens of policy and advocacy. They will need to engage in value-driven, advanced social policy practice through integrating theory, diversity, practice, results, and outcomes.
- Task:** Students will complete a policy analysis paper exploring a current social issue that impacts a marginalized and or oppressed population. The final paper should include at least the following sections:
- **Identification and Research of Social Issue and Policy:** Select a current social issue and a specific related policy (e.g., immigration law, welfare reform). Analyze how the issue and policy affect marginalized and oppressed populations. Research and describe how the policy operates across different system levels (e.g., local, state, tribal, federal). Use evidence and data to inform the identification of challenges and potential solutions.
 - **Ethical and Human Rights Analysis:** Summarize the key issues and findings of your analysis. Review how the social construction of the target population influences the policy's design and implementation. Compare the policy to both the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the NASW Code of Ethics, identifying areas of alignment or conflict and specific rights or principles that are upheld or violated.
 - **Application of Social Policy Theory:** Use a social policy theory (e.g., political economy, social construction, cost-benefit, feminist theory, critical race theory, etc.) to examine the policy. Discuss how the policy affects individuals, families, groups, communities, and organizations. Support your analysis and the theory description with scholarly research.
 - **Policy Alternatives and Advocacy Recommendations:** Present two or more policy alternatives. Evaluate how well each aligns with ethical standards and human rights principles. Clearly propose a policy adjustment and outline a realistic strategy for legislative advocacy and justice-based reform.
- Success:** A successful submission will demonstrate students' ability to analyze social policy and promote social justice with a clear focus on how marginalized and oppressed populations are impacted across local, state, tribal, and federal levels. The paper will reflect the integration of scholarship to understand the social challenges and potential solutions. Students will provide a basis for social policy theory, describe it, and engage in meaningful discussions relating it to social policy. Students' papers will be well-organized, demonstrating high-quality work and following the assignment expectations.

Assignment 03b Policy Advocacy Presentation

- Meta:** *Points* 100 points (30% of final grade); *Deadline* is due no later than 08:00 AM on Monday, 07/13/26; *Completion* via forum submission in MyHeritage with faculty score upload to Anthology;

Purpose: The policy advocacy presentation builds on your written policy analysis by developing a compelling and well-structured advocacy presentation. Students will practice translating complex policy ideas into a format suitable for stakeholder engagement.

Task: Create an approximately 10-minute video presentation that builds upon your written policy analysis paper. Your presentation should include a visual element that helps summarize the content you are sharing (e.g., consider using presentation slides). This presentation should be structured as follows:

- **Introduction:** Present a clear and concise problem statement, identifying the social issue and briefly summarizing its root causes. Set the stage for why this issue matters and who it impacts.
- **Policy Analysis:** Provide an overview of the effectiveness of past and current policy efforts related to the issue. Analyze their impact across different system levels (micro, mezzo, macro). Include an analysis of stakeholders, identifying key decision-makers, supporters, advocacy organizations, or community members, and potential opponents.
- **Advocacy Strategy:** Describe your advocacy goal and objective. Identify your target audience and map out the relevant actors. Share your key advocacy messages, connecting them to the audience's values or concerns. Highlight approaches that can be used to advance your message. Include a persuasive call to action that reinforces urgency and purpose.
- **Implementation Plan:** Outline clear action steps along with associated roles, responsibilities, timeline, and resources. Address how you will monitor and evaluate progress. Explain the feasibility of your plan, accounting for real-world barriers, political dynamics, and enabling conditions.
- **Conclusion:** Summarize the key points from your presentation. Reflect on the potential social, racial, economic, and environmental justice implications of the policy issue and proposed solution. Reiterate the significance of the issue and inspire your audience toward action.

Success: A successful presentation will clearly explain the social issue and policy context, provide a well-supported advocacy strategy, and include a realistic implementation plan. It will demonstrate an understanding of key stakeholders, power dynamics, and barriers to change. The video will be organized, persuasive, and reflect core social work values, with thoughtful attention to justice and equity.

Assignment 04 Take Home Exams

Meta: Points 50 points each for a total of 100 points (20% of final grade); Deadline Both exams are due on Mondays, no later than 08:00 AM, with Exam 01 being due 06/22/26 and Exam 02 being due 07/20/26; Completion via MyHeritage assignments;

Purpose: Demonstrate your understanding of course topics and readings through applied, reflective examination.

Task: Complete two take-home exams administered on MyHeritage. Each exam consists of 10 questions, is open-book, and includes an extra-credit question. The first exam

covers content from Linquiti's (2022), including chapters 1-4, and the second one covers chapters 5-10.

Success: Students will accurately answer the questions on the exams, drawing the assigned readings.

Course Guidelines and Expectations

Description of course expectations

Students engage in asynchronous forums and other significant assignments, where they are expected to demonstrate high-quality scholarship and ethical writing practices. In the forums, students are expected to provide in-depth, considered discussions about their learning and experiences in dialogue with their peers. During the synchronous class session, there will be activities and opportunities for students to explore ideas and practice relevant skills. Students should be prepared by reviewing the week's course content and adopting an experimental mindset and a willingness to try new approaches.

Description of Assignment Types

Asynchronous participation and engagement through discussion forums on MyHeritage is the most significant aspect of this class. These forums ask students to present work, learning, and reflections in conversation with their peers. Students attend synchronous class sessions where they advanced practice policy skills. There are other, larger assignments that students will also complete, including a policy analysis paper, a policy advocacy presentation, and two take-home exams.

Designated Style

Students should follow the American Psychological Association (APA, 2020) style guide for all writing done in this course. While optional for this course, their seventh-in-edition style guide can be a valuable asset to supporting student scholarship.

Course Schedule

The planned course schedule is as follows:

Week	Date	Content	Reading Assignment	Due Dates
1	5/25 - 5/31 Class 5/30	Asynchronous: Writing Problem Definitions and Engaging with Contemporary Welfare Policy In-Class: Foundations of Advanced Policy Practice: Prospective Analysis and Defining the Problem	Course syllabus; Linquiti (2022) Ch 1; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Introduction	A-01 Replies for W-01 due 8 AM Monday (6/1) via MyHeritage Forums
2	6/1 - 6/7 Asynchronous	Retrospective Analysis, Logic Models, and Rethinking Policy Analysis	MSW Program Student Handbook; Linquiti (2022) Ch 2 and Ch 3; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 1	A-01 Replies for W-02 due 8 AM Monday (6/8) via MyHeritage Forums

Week	Date	Content	Reading Assignment	Due Dates
3	6/8 - 6/14 Class 5/13	Asynchronous: Applying Metacognitive Awareness and Exploring Rural and Migrant Poverty In-Class: Using Metacognition to Check Biases	Linquiti (2022) Ch 4; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 2	A-01 Replies for W-03 due 8 AM Monday (6/15) via MyHeritage Forums
4	6/15 - 6/21 Asynchronous	Logic, Evidence, and the Policy Analyst's Toolkit	Linquiti (2022) Ch 5 and Ch 6; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 3	A-01 Replies for W-04 due 8 AM Monday (6/22) via MyHeritage Forums; and A-04 Take Home Exam 01 due 8 AM Monday (6/22) via MyHeritage Assignments
5	6/22 - 6/28 Class 6/27	Asynchronous: Critiquing Policy Claims, Fermi Estimation, and Poverty Policy Connections In-Class: The Mindset of an Effective Policy Analyst	Linquiti (2022) Ch 7; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 4	A-01 Replies for W-05 due 8 AM Monday (6/29) via MyHeritage Forums
6	6/29 - 7/5 Asynchronous	Equity and Economic Lenses: Analyzing Policy Through an Ethics and Justice Framework	Linquiti (2022) Ch 8 and Ch 9; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 5	A-01 Replies for W-06 due 8 AM Monday (7/6) via MyHeritage Forums; and A-03a Policy Analysis Paper due 8 AM Monday (7/6) via Anthology
7	7/6 - 7/12 Class 7/11	Asynchronous: Completing the Policy Analysis Framework: Political, Institutional, and Specialized Lenses In-Class: MSW Program Evaluation & Career Day	Linquiti (2022) Ch 10 and Ch 11; Edin and Shaefer (2016) Ch 6	A-01 Replies for W-07 due 8 AM Monday (7/13) via MyHeritage Forums; and A-03b Policy Advocacy Presentation due 8 AM Monday (7/13) via MyHeritage Forums;
8	7/13 - 7/19 Asynchronous	Systems Thinking, Futures Visioning, and Integrating the Course	Linquiti (2022) Ch 12 and Ch 13	A-01 Replies for W-08 due 8 AM Monday (7/20) via MyHeritage Forums; A-04 Take Home Exam 02 due 8 AM Monday (7/20) via MyHeritage Assignments; Course Evaluations via MyHeritage CourseEval; and Final Grades submitted by Instructor Wednesday (7/22) by 5 PM;

Attendance

Regular attendance and class participation are expected and considered essential for successful academic work. Heritage regularly updates its full attendance policy available in the current catalog: [Attendance Policy](#). Remember that Heritage University Student Affairs is ready to help solve problems that interfere with attending class. Email them at studentaffairs@heritage.edu.

Reasonable Accommodation for Religious Holidays

Consistent with Heritage University's mission and values and pursuant to RCW [28B.137.010](#) as amended, and Substitute Senate Bill 5166, HU allows student reasonable absences for reasons of faith or for organized activities conducted under the auspices of a religious denomination, church, or religious organization. The student requesting an excused absence for reasons of faith must submit the Request for Absence for Reasons of Faith Form to their instructor(s) at least two (2) weeks prior to the beginning of the semester in which the absence is anticipated to occur. The form is located on the Student Forms page under the Students Tab in MyHeritage. Full policy and procedures are located in the current catalog under Academic Policies, Attendance.

Support and Resources

Tutoring at the Academic Skills Center [Log into MyHeritage before using links]

The ASC has in-person and online appointments, drop-in services also both in-person and online. To view our schedule, or make an in-person or online appointment, visit the ASC page on MyHeritage under Student Services. To learn more about any of these services, call the ASC at (509) 865-8517 or email us ASC@heritage.edu.

Library

The librarians are here to assist you! Use the online chat on the [HU Library Website](#). For research and general assistance, feel free to stop by, call a reference librarian at (509) 865-8520, or email Library@heritage.edu.

Credit Hour Requirements

Federal regulations require that all courses follow the Heritage University definition of a credit hour as described in HU Policy. For the current policy, see the catalog entry [credit hour policy](#).

Online Course Exchange Appeals Process

Online Course Exchange students who wish to appeal an instructor's or facilitator's decision or request assistance with academic issues (such as requesting an incomplete or an extension) should contact HU's Online Course Exchange Liaison at Acadeum@heritage.edu.

Academic Honesty

Heritage University students have the responsibility to adhere to academic honesty in all their educational endeavors. Faculty has the responsibility to model academic honesty and to prevent, detect, and confront students who violate it. See [Academic Honesty Policy](#) and [Academic Honesty Procedure Diagram](#).

Campus Security & Safety

In an emergency, call 911. If you need campus security assistance between 8 a.m. and 5 p.m., please call 509-865-8555 or ext. 8555 from any campus landline or email: CampusSecurity@heritage.edu. For a list of Campus Security services and Crisis Response Steps, see the [Safety and Security webpage](#).

Accommodations

For information about student disability services on campus, please visit the [Office of Disability Services \(ADA\) | Heritage University](#) webpage or email Officeofdisabilityservices@heritage.edu.

Safe Attendance Reminder

Heritage University is committed to providing a safe and healthy environment for all students, staff, and faculty. Our goal is to mitigate the potential for transmission of communicable diseases, including COVID-19, in our environment.

Anyone experiencing symptoms of viral illness, such as fever or chills, cough, fatigue, muscle or body aches, headache, new loss of taste or smell, sore throat, congestion or runny nose, nausea or vomiting, or diarrhea, should stay home and see medical attention. Anyone known to have a close exposure to COVID-19 should wear a mask and follow [CDC guidelines](#) for isolation and precautions.

In addition, Heritage University community members must be prepared to “Mask When Asked.” Individuals can require that people who enter their offices wear masks. Faculty can require that students mask in their classrooms. Students who need to have their classmates mask can request that themselves or speak to the Vice President for Student Affairs to ask for support. Our collective commitment to health and wellbeing of all members of the community is essential and appreciated.

References

- American Psychological Association. (2020). *Publication manual of the American Psychological Association* (7th ed.). American Psychological Association. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0000165-000>
- Council on Social Work Education. (2022). *2022 EPAS: Educational policy and accreditation standards for baccalaureate and master's social work programs*. <https://www.cswe.org/accreditation/policies-process/2022epas/>
- Edin, K. J., & Shaefer, H. L. (2016). *\$2.00 A Day: Living on almost nothing in America*. HarperCollins.
- Linquiti, P. D. (2022). *Rebooting policy analysis: Strengthening the foundation, expanding the scope*. CQ Press.

Appendix

A. Policy Analysis Paper and Competency 2 Practice Behaviors Rubric

The *Policy Analysis Paper and Competency 2 Practice Behaviors Rubric* assesses students' ability to critically examine a current social issue and its related policy across multiple system levels, with a focus on how marginalized and oppressed populations are impacted. The rubric assesses students' advanced policy practice skills (e.g., ability to gather and synthesize relevant data, apply ethical reasoning, and analyze policy through theoretical frameworks). It also measures the depth of students' engagement with human rights standards and professional social work values. High-quality submissions will demonstrate scholarly rigor using APA formatting and follow the assignment expectations.

B. Policy Advocacy Presentation and Competency 5 Practice Behaviors Rubric

The *Policy Advocacy Presentation and Competency 5 Practice Behaviors Rubric* evaluates students' ability to communicate their policy analysis through a strategic and persuasive advocacy presentation. It measures students' skills in articulating a clear problem statement, analyzing stakeholder roles, developing advocacy goals and messages, and proposing a realistic implementation plan. The rubric also assesses students' attention to power dynamics, barriers to change, and implications for social, racial, and economic justice. Effective presentations will be organized, professional, and grounded in advocacy strategies aligned with social work values and competencies.

Syllabus Form Updated 5-27-2025 (MJ)

A. Policy Analysis Paper and Competency 2 Practice Behaviors Rubric

Description	Initial	Emerging	Developed	Highly Developed
Competency 2: Advance Human Rights and Social, Racial, Economic, and Environmental Justice a. Utilize policy analysis skills to inform policy formulation practices and policy implementation effects on oppressed and marginalized populations, including rural and tribal communities. b. Organize legislative policy advocacy with individuals, families, groups, communities, and organizations to advance human rights and social, economic, and environmental justice.				
Identify and research of a social issue and policy.	The social issue and applicable policy are not clearly identified, with minimal or no examination of how they affect marginalized and oppressed communities. Demonstrates minimal understanding of policy at system levels. Lacks sufficient research and evidence to inform potential solutions and challenges.	The social issue and applicable policy are identified, but there is limited examination of their impact on marginalized and oppressed communities. Demonstrates a limited understanding of policy at 2–3 levels. Provides limited research and evidence to inform potential challenges and solutions.	The social issue and applicable policy are identified and examined, with some focus on how they affect marginalized and oppressed populations. Demonstrates a fair understanding of policy at 3–4 levels. Requires more research and evidence to better inform potential challenges and solutions.	The social issue and applicable policy are clearly and skillfully identified and examined, with a strong focus on their impact on marginalized and oppressed populations. Demonstrates a deep understanding of policy at all levels. Provides thorough research and evidence to inform potential challenges and solutions.
Analyze policy related to ethical and human rights.	Minimal to no analysis of the social construction of the population and its impact on policy. Needs a comparison of how the policy aligns or conflicts with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and NASW Code of Ethics. Does not identify specific rights or principles that are upheld or violated.	Basic analysis of the social construction of the population, but with gaps in how it shapes policy or missing important dynamics. Basic comparison of how the policy aligns or conflicts with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and NASW Code of Ethics. Minimal identification of specific rights or principles that are upheld or violated.	Provides an analysis of the social construction of the population but lacks full depth or connection to broader policy impacts. Offers a comparison of how the policy aligns or conflicts with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and NASW Code of Ethics but lacks detail in identifying specific rights or principles that are upheld or violated.	Deeply analyzes how the social construction of the target population shapes policy, addressing power dynamics and societal perceptions. Provides a thorough comparison of how the policy aligns or conflicts with the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and NASW Code of Ethics. Clearly identifies specific rights or principles that are upheld or violated.

Description	Initial	Emerging	Developed	Highly Developed
Analysis of social policy theories and effects on all levels.	Minimal application of social policy theories as they relate to practice with diverse client populations. No evidence of research to support policy change recommendations.	Limited integration and application of social policy theories as they relate to practice with diverse client populations. Limited evidence of research in preparation for policy change recommendations.	Some incorporation of social policy theories as they relate to practice with diverse client populations. Some evidence of research in preparation for policy change recommendations.	Strong incorporation of social policy theories as they relate to practice with diverse client populations. Strong evidence of research in preparation for policy change recommendations.
Policy options or alternatives.	Paper needs clear recommendations for policy adjustments or is incomplete. There is minimal to no connection to legislative policy advocacy.	Paper has basic recommendations for policy adjustment or incomplete. Weak connections to legislative policy advocacy.	Paper provides some recommendations for policy adjustment, needs depth or clarity in linking adjustments to human rights and ethics. Some connection to legislative policy advocacy.	Paper is thoughtful and well-reasoned recommendations for policy adjustment that align with human rights and ethical standards, with clear connections to legislative policy advocacy and justice.
General Assignment Requirements				
Organization, Clarity, and APA Formatting	The brief lacks clear organization; tone is informal or inappropriate for a policy audience; citations and references are missing.	Some organization is evident but ideas may be disjointed; tone is uneven or somewhat unprofessional; several APA citation errors are present.	The brief is generally well-organized with a mostly professional tone; minor APA formatting errors are present but do not detract significantly from clarity.	The brief is clearly and logically organized with a consistently professional, action-oriented tone; APA citations and references are accurate and properly formatted throughout.
Following assignment requirements	Does not follow the assignment description.	Somewhat follows the assignment description, but significant errors exist.	Follows the assignment description and requirements but has minor errors.	Closely follows the assignment description and requirements.

B. Policy Advocacy Presentation and Competency 5 Practice Behaviors Rubric

Description	Initial	Emerging	Developed	Highly Developed
Competency 5: Engage in Policy Practice a. Examine social policies at local, state, tribal, and federal levels to provide best practice recommendations. b. Assess social policy theory in the context of practice with diverse client populations and prepare recommendations for policy change.				
Introduction: Problem statement	Presentation has no clear introduction of problem statement, needs to address the issue and demonstrate understanding of root causes.	Presentation has a basic introduction to problem statement, may need more clarification on understanding the root cause.	Presentation provides an overview of the problem statement, somewhat addresses the issue and understanding of the root causes.	Presentation provides a detailed overview of problem statement, pinpoints the issue and understanding the root causes.
Policy analysis	Presentation is missing the assessment of the effectiveness of current and past policy efforts and their effects on all levels. Presentation is missing stakeholder analysis identifies key decision makers, supporters, advocacy groups, community members, and opponents.	Presentation has an incomplete assessment of the effectiveness of current and past policy efforts or their effects on all levels. The stakeholder analysis is incomplete, missing key decision makers, supporters, advocacy groups, community members, or opponents.	Presentation includes a clear assessment of the effectiveness of current and past policy efforts and their effects on all levels. It identifies key decision makers, supporters, advocacy groups, community members, and opponents.	Presentation clearly and thoroughly assesses the effectiveness of current and past policy efforts and their effects on all levels. It clearly identifies key decision makers, supporters, advocacy groups, community members, and opponents.

Description	Initial	Emerging	Developed	Highly Developed
Advocacy strategy	Presentation provides minimal to no information on goals, objectives, target audience, power mapping, or key advocacy messages. There is no mention of direct lobbying, grassroots lobbying, or policy alternatives within the advocacy strategy. Presentation needs an effective call to action that ties together policy analysis, emphasizes urgency and encourages further thought/action.	Presentation has incomplete information on goals, objectives, target audience, power mapping, and key advocacy messages. It briefly touches on direct lobbying, grassroots lobbying, or policy alternatives. Call to action is present, but does not tie together policy analysis, emphasizes on urgency, encouragement of further thought/action.	Presentation includes good information on goals, objectives, target audience, and power mapping. The key advocacy message resonates well. It connects direct lobbying, grassroots lobbying, and/or policy alternatives to the advocacy strategy. The call to action ties the policy analysis together, emphasizes urgency, and encourages further thought or action.	Complete information on goals/objectives, target audience, power mapping. Key advocacy message is sharp and resonates emotionally. Presentation strongly connects direct lobbying, grassroots lobbying and policy alternatives to advocacy strategy. Compelling call to action that ties together policy analysis, emphasizes urgency, and encourages further thought and action.
Implementation plan	Presentation provides minimal to no information on the implementation plan, including action steps, roles, responsibilities, timeline, resources, monitoring, and evaluation. Policy recommendations are either absent or disconnected from the analysis and evidence. Feasibility of implementation is not addressed or realistically assessed.	Presentation is missing 1-2 sections of the implementation plan, such as action steps, roles, responsibilities, timeline, resources, monitoring, or evaluation. Policy recommendations are somewhat related to the analysis but are vague, broad, or lack evidence. Feasibility is mentioned but with limited or superficial engagement with barriers, challenges, and enablers.	Presentation includes an implementation plan with action steps, roles, responsibilities, timeline, resources, monitoring, and evaluation. Policy recommendations are generally well-supported by the analysis but may need more detail or specificity. Feasibility is considered, but there is a lack of depth in exploring challenges, barriers, or enablers to implementation.	Presentation clearly incorporates an implementation plan with detailed action steps, roles, responsibilities, timeline, resources, monitoring, and evaluation. Policy recommendations are specific, actionable, well-supported by the analysis, and reflect a deep understanding of the issue and potential solutions. Demonstrates a realistic understanding of potential barriers, challenges, and enablers to implementation.

Description	Initial	Emerging	Developed	Highly Developed
Conclusion	Presentation slides and information need a summary of the main findings from the analysis. There is minimal to no reflection on the policy's potential impact, consideration of oppressed and marginalized populations, levels, and or ADEI dimensions.	Presentation slides offer a basic summary of the main findings, synthesizing key issues, evidence, and arguments. They provide a superficial reflection on the policy's impact, lacking adequate consideration of all populations, levels, and ADEI dimensions.	Presentation slides provide a solid summary of the main findings, effectively synthesizing key issues, evidence, and arguments without introducing new information. Presentation reflects on the policy's impact on all groups but need more depth in addressing all ADEI dimensions.	Presentation slides clearly and concisely summarize the main findings, effectively synthesizing key issues, evidence, and arguments without introducing new information. Presentation thoughtfully reflects on the social, racial, economic, and environmental justice impacts of the policy and recommendations, addressing all groups, levels and dimensions of ADEI.
General Assignment Requirements				
Professional presentation that is well organized and high-quality	The has significant problems following assignment requirements and is hard to follow and has major problems in facilitation.	The has some significant problems following assignment requirements, but the presentation is acceptable.	The presentation has some minor problems following assignment requirements but is generally a well done presentation.	The presentation follows all of the assignment requirements and is clear, well-structured, professional, engaging.